

Dashboard

The Dashboard provides a centralized overview of your DevArt RSS Widgets installation, cache status, feed activity, embed usage and maintenance tools.

DevArt RSS Widgets is built around a cache-first architecture. Frontend output never reads remote RSS feeds directly. All frontend rendering uses generated JSON cache files, making the system suitable for high-traffic Joomla websites, Cloudflare deployments and external widget distribution.

Widgets

The Widgets section is the main management area of the component.

From here you can create, edit and manage RSS widgets, configure feed sources, select templates, configure embeds, analytics and privacy settings, and generate iframe or JavaScript embed codes.

Widgets can be displayed inside Joomla using the included module, embedded inside Joomla content using the content plugin, or published on external websites through iframe and JavaScript embeds.

Settings

The Settings area contains global component configuration.

Available options include cache defaults, image cache retention, domain access policies, administrator permissions (ACL) and uninstall preservation settings.

Most display and feed settings remain configurable individually inside each widget.

Domain Usage

Domain Usage displays external domains currently using your embedded widgets.

This registry helps administrators verify widget usage, identify unexpected embed locations and audit external deployments.

No visitor analytics or request counters are stored.

Fetch / Cache Status

The Dashboard displays the current status of the system.

Widgets

Shows the number of configured and published widgets.

RSS Feeds

Displays the total number of RSS feed sources configured across all widgets.

Cached Items

Shows the total number of cached RSS items currently available for frontend rendering.

Cache Files

Displays the number and total size of generated JSON cache files.

Cached Images

Displays the number and total size of locally cached images used by widgets.

Last Fetch

Shows the latest RSS retrieval attempt.

Last Success

Shows the latest successful RSS retrieval.

Cache Maintenance

Clear JSON Cache

Removes generated JSON cache files.

Use this when testing widget changes, troubleshooting feed updates or forcing cache regeneration.

Clear Image Cache

Removes locally cached images.

Use this when testing image settings, rebuilding image cache or reclaiming storage space.

Images will be regenerated automatically during the next successful RSS fetch.

Cache-First Architecture

DevArt RSS Widgets uses a cache-first design optimized for production websites.

Frontend rendering:

- Reads JSON cache only
- Never downloads RSS feeds
- Never parses remote feeds
- Minimizes external requests
- Reduces server load

RSS retrieval occurs only through:

- Fetch Now
- External Cron URL
- Joomla Scheduled Tasks

This architecture improves performance, reliability, scalability and Cloudflare compatibility.

Cloudflare Cache Note

DevArt RSS Widgets works safely with normal Joomla page caching and Cloudflare caching.

If refresh intervals of one to two hours or more are acceptable, Cloudflare bypass rules are usually not required.

For iframe or JavaScript embeds that must refresh independently from full-page Cloudflare cache, create a Cloudflare Cache Rule:

URI Query String contains:

option=com_devart_rss_widgets

AND

view=embed

Action:

Bypass Cache

Internal Joomla module rendering can remain cached normally.

Analytics & Privacy

Analytics tracking applies only to iframe and JavaScript embeds.

Internal Joomla module rendering is never tracked by this feature.

When enabled:

- Google Analytics 4 events can be sent
- Consent can be required before tracking
- Users can change consent at any time through the Privacy link
- Optional Privacy Policy URLs can be displayed inside the consent panel

Production Recommendations

For high-traffic websites:

- Enable caching
- Use image caching where appropriate
- Use Joomla Scheduled Tasks or Cron URLs for automated feed updates
- Avoid excessively short refresh intervals
- Test Cloudflare cache behavior when using external embeds

Settings

The Settings page contains the global configuration options for DevArt RSS Widgets. These settings affect how widgets fetch RSS feeds, manage cache, handle embeds, enforce domain restrictions and preserve data during uninstall operations.

Most display, template and content settings remain configurable individually inside each widget.

Fetch Mode

Controls how RSS feeds are refreshed automatically.

Joomla Scheduled Task

Uses Joomla's built-in Scheduled Tasks system to periodically refresh RSS feeds.

Suitable for:

- Standard Joomla installations
- Shared hosting environments
- Administrators who prefer Joomla-native scheduling

External Cron URL (Recommended)

Uses a secure Cron URL that can be executed directly by the server scheduler.

Recommended for:

- Production websites
- High-traffic installations
- Cloudflare deployments
- Large numbers of RSS feeds

External cron jobs are generally more reliable than Joomla Scheduled Tasks on busy websites.

Cron Token

The Cron Token secures the automatic RSS fetch endpoint.

Only requests containing the correct token can trigger feed updates.

Generate Token

Creates a new random security token.

After generating a new token:

1. Save the settings.
2. Update any existing cron jobs.
3. Replace old URLs with the new token.

Cron URL

A ready-to-use URL for automated RSS fetching.

This URL can be used in:

- Plesk Scheduled Tasks
- cPanel Cron Jobs
- Webmin Cron Jobs
- Linux cron
- External monitoring services

Only feed retrieval is performed. Frontend visitors never trigger RSS downloads.

Cron Command

Provides a ready-to-copy command-line cron example.

Suitable for:

- Linux servers
- VPS environments
- Dedicated servers
- Plesk and Webmin scheduled tasks

Using the command-line version is generally preferred when server access is available.

Joomla Scheduled Task

Information panel explaining Scheduled Task integration.

To use Joomla scheduling:

1. Enable the DevArt RSS Widgets Scheduler plugin.
2. Create a Joomla Scheduled Task.
3. Select the DevArt RSS fetch routine.

For high-traffic production environments, the external Cron URL remains the recommended option.

Cache Lifetime

Defines how long generated JSON cache files remain valid.

After expiration, the next scheduled fetch will regenerate the cache.

Typical values:

- 300 seconds (5 minutes)
- 900 seconds (15 minutes)
- 1800 seconds (30 minutes)
- 3600 seconds (1 hour)

Shorter values provide fresher content while longer values reduce server activity.

Preserve Widget Data On Uninstall

Keeps widget database records when uninstalling the extension.

When enabled:

- Widgets remain stored
- Feed settings remain stored
- Embed settings remain stored
- Reinstallation can restore previous configuration

Recommended when temporary removal or manual upgrades are expected.

Preserve Generated Cache Files On Uninstall

Keeps generated JSON cache files inside:

`/media/com_devart_rss_widgets/cache`

Useful when:

- Reinstalling the extension
- Testing upgrades
- Preserving cached content

Normally this option can remain disabled.

Preserve Uploaded Images On Uninstall

Keeps uploaded logos and fallback images inside:

`/media/com_devart_rss_widgets/uploads`

Recommended when:

- Custom branding has been configured
 - Uploaded assets should survive reinstallations
-

Enable Domain Usage Registry

Enables the optional embedded domain registry.

When enabled, DevArt RSS Widgets records which external domains are using embedded widgets.

Features:

- Records domains only
- No visitor tracking
- No hit counters
- No analytics profiling
- Updates are throttled to minimize storage

Useful for auditing external widget usage.

Domain Access Policy

Controls which external websites may load iframe embeds.

Allow All Domains

Any external website may display embedded widgets.

Suitable for:

- Public widget distribution
- Open content syndication

Use Allow List

Only domains listed in the Allowed Domains field may load embedded widgets.

Recommended for:

- Private widget networks
- Corporate environments
- Controlled distribution

Use Block List

All domains may load widgets except domains listed in the Blocked Domains field.

Useful when a small number of domains must be excluded.

Module rendering and Joomla content rendering are not affected by these rules.

Allowed Domains

List of domains permitted to load iframe embeds when the Allow List policy is active.

Examples:

- devart.gr
- widgets.devart.gr
- example.com

One domain per line is recommended.

Blocked Domains

List of domains prohibited from loading iframe embeds when the Block List policy is active.

Examples:

- badsite.com
- unwanted-domain.net

One domain per line is recommended.

Permissions

The Permissions tab uses Joomla's native ACL system.

Administrators can control access to:

- Component administration
- Widget creation
- Widget editing
- Widget deletion
- Publishing actions
- RSS fetching operations
- Configuration management

This allows different administrator groups to manage widgets while restricting access to sensitive settings.

Production Recommendations

For production websites:

- Use External Cron URL whenever possible.
- Set Cache Lifetime between 15 and 60 minutes.
- Enable Preserve Widget Data On Uninstall.
- Enable Preserve Uploaded Images On Uninstall.
- Use an Allow List for private widget deployments.
- Enable Domain Usage Registry when distributing widgets to external websites.

- Rotate Cron Tokens if unauthorized access is suspected.

These settings provide the best balance between performance, security and maintainability for high-traffic Joomla installations.

Domain Usage

The Domain Usage page provides visibility into which external websites are currently using your embedded RSS widgets.

This feature is optional and is disabled by default.

When enabled, DevArt RSS Widgets records basic embed usage information for iframe and JavaScript widget deployments without storing visitor statistics or personal data.

Purpose

Domain Usage helps administrators identify where their widgets are being displayed across external websites.

Typical use cases include:

- Auditing widget distribution
- Verifying partner websites
- Detecting unauthorized widget usage
- Monitoring private widget networks
- Validating allow-list and block-list policies

The registry is informational only and is not intended as a traffic analytics system.

Privacy and Data Collection

The registry stores only minimal technical information:

- Widget ID
- Widget title
- External domain name
- First Seen date
- Last Seen date
- Access status

The system does not store:

- Visitor counts
- Page views
- IP addresses
- User identifiers

- Analytics profiles
- Personal information

Updates are throttled to at most one registry update per widget/domain/day to minimize database activity.

Search and Filtering

The filter field allows searching by:

- Domain name
- Widget title
- Widget alias

Use the search box to quickly locate specific websites or widgets.

The page size selector controls how many registry entries are displayed per page.

Registry Columns

ID

Internal registry record identifier.

Widget

Displays the widget associated with the recorded domain.

Clicking the widget title opens the widget for editing.

Domain

The external website where the widget was detected.

Examples:

- example.com
- widgets.example.com
- partner-site.net

Only the domain name is stored.

Status

Shows whether the domain was successfully recorded by the registry system.

Possible values:

- Allowed
- Blocked
- Unknown

This reflects the registry record state and embed validation result.

Access

Displays whether the current Domain Access Policy permits widget usage from that domain.

Possible values:

Allowed

The domain is currently permitted by the active domain policy.

Blocked

The domain is currently denied by the active domain policy.

A blocked domain will not be able to load iframe embeds even if it appears in the registry.

First Seen

Date and time when the domain was first detected using the widget.

Useful for determining when an embed was initially deployed.

Last Seen

Date and time of the most recent successful registry update for the domain.

Useful for identifying:

- Active widget deployments
 - Recently used embeds
 - Stale or abandoned widget installations
-

Relationship with Domain Access Policies

Domain Usage works together with the global Domain Access Policy configured in Settings.

Depending on the selected policy:

Allow All Domains

All external domains may load embedded widgets.

The registry is informational only.

Use Allow List

Only domains listed in Allowed Domains may display widgets.

Any unapproved domains will be denied access.

Use Block List

All domains are permitted except domains explicitly listed in Blocked Domains.

Performance

The Domain Usage Registry is designed for minimal overhead.

Features include:

- Lightweight database storage
- One update per widget/domain/day
- No request counters
- No visitor statistics
- No analytics processing
- Cloudflare-friendly operation

The registry has negligible impact even on high-traffic websites.

Recommended Usage

Enable Domain Usage Registry when:

- Distributing widgets to external websites
- Operating partner or affiliate networks
- Restricting widget usage with allow-lists
- Monitoring where content is being embedded

It can remain disabled when widgets are used only inside the local Joomla website.

Important Note

Domain Usage is not an analytics platform.

Its purpose is simply to record which domains are using embedded widgets while preserving privacy and minimizing server load. No visitor tracking, hit counting, or personal data collection is performed.

Widgets

The Widgets section is the core management area of DevArt RSS Widgets. Here you create, edit, publish and maintain RSS widget profiles that can be displayed inside Joomla websites or embedded on external websites using iframe or JavaScript embed codes.

Each widget contains its own feed configuration, template settings, branding options, embed controls and content display preferences.

Purpose

Widgets allow you to transform one or multiple RSS feeds into reusable content blocks that can be displayed:

- Inside Joomla modules
- Inside Joomla articles using shortcodes
- On external websites using iframe embeds
- On external websites using JavaScript embeds

A single widget can be reused across multiple websites and locations.

Widget List

The main Widgets screen displays all configured widgets.

Available information includes:

- Widget ID
- Widget title
- Alias
- Publication status
- Selected template
- Number of configured feeds
- Last fetch date
- Cache status

Standard Joomla toolbar actions are available for managing widgets.

Creating a Widget

To create a new widget:

1. Open Widgets.
2. Click New.
3. Enter a widget title.

4. Configure feed sources.
5. Select a template.
6. Adjust content and branding settings.
7. Save the widget.

After saving, the widget becomes available for modules, shortcodes and external embeds.

Widget Configuration Areas

Each widget is organized into multiple tabs.

General

Basic widget information.

Includes:

- Title
 - Alias
 - Published state
 - Description
 - Administrative notes
-

Data

Controls RSS feed retrieval and content collection.

Options include:

- RSS feed URLs
- Total items limit
- Items per feed
- Feed ordering
- Cache lifetime
- Fetch status
- Manual Fetch Now action

Multiple RSS feeds can be combined into a single widget.

Template

Controls how content is displayed.

Includes:

- Template selection
- Theme presets

- Typography controls
- Image settings
- Date display
- Source display
- Intro text settings
- Read More settings
- Column layouts
- Hover effects
- Color customization

Templates can be configured independently without affecting other widgets.

Branding

Controls widget branding and visual identity.

Options include:

- Header display
- Footer display
- Logo display
- Fallback image
- Custom logo
- Custom footer text

Branding settings are useful when widgets are embedded on external websites.

Embed

Controls external widget distribution.

Includes:

- Iframe embed code
- JavaScript embed code
- Domain policy information
- Height settings
- Auto height support
- Fixed height fallback
- Preview tools

Widgets can be distributed to other websites directly from this section.

Fetch Now

The Fetch Now button performs an immediate RSS refresh for the selected widget.

During a fetch operation:

1. RSS feeds are downloaded.
2. Feed items are validated.
3. Images are processed if required.
4. JSON cache is regenerated.
5. Frontend output is updated.

Frontend visitors never trigger RSS downloads.

All feed processing occurs through:

- Fetch Now
 - Scheduled Tasks
 - External Cron
-

Publishing Widgets

Only published widgets can be displayed.

Unpublished widgets remain available for editing but are hidden from frontend output.

Publishing can be controlled through:

- Widget status
 - Joomla ACL permissions
 - Module assignments
-

Using Widgets Inside Joomla

Widgets can be displayed using:

Joomla Module

Create or edit the DevArt RSS Widget module and select the desired widget.

Recommended for:

- Homepage content
- Sidebars
- Category pages
- Landing pages

Shortcodes

Insert the widget directly inside Joomla content using the provided shortcode.

Useful for:

- Articles
 - Pages
 - Custom layouts
-

Using Widgets On External Websites

Every widget can generate:

Iframe Embed

Simple integration suitable for most websites.

Benefits:

- Fast setup
- Isolated rendering
- Works on virtually any platform

JavaScript Embed

Provides automatic height adjustment and a more seamless integration experience.

Benefits:

- No internal scrolling
- Automatic content height detection
- Better responsive behavior
- Cleaner visual integration

JavaScript embeds are recommended whenever possible.

Auto Height vs Fixed Height

Embed widgets support two height modes.

Auto Height

The embedded widget automatically adjusts its height to match its content.

Recommended for:

- Responsive websites
- Variable item counts
- Different screen sizes

Fixed Height

Uses a fixed iframe height.

Recommended only when a strict layout height is required.

The Fallback Height value is used if automatic height detection is unavailable.

Cache-First Architecture

Widgets use a cache-first design.

Frontend output never downloads RSS feeds directly.

Instead:

1. RSS feeds are fetched in the background.
2. Processed content is stored as JSON cache.
3. Frontend output reads only generated cache files.

Benefits include:

- Faster page loading
 - Lower server load
 - Better Cloudflare compatibility
 - Reduced external feed dependency
 - Improved stability during feed outages
-

Cloudflare Compatibility

Widgets work correctly with Joomla cache and Cloudflare.

For most websites:

- No Cloudflare bypass rule is required.
- JSON cache can safely remain cached.

If embedded widgets must refresh independently from full-page Cloudflare cache, create a bypass rule only for embed endpoints.

Normal Joomla module rendering can remain cached.

Import and Export

Widgets can be exported and imported between Joomla installations.

Export includes:

- Widget settings
- Feed configuration
- Template settings
- Branding options

- Embed settings

Export does not include:

- Runtime cache
- Image cache
- Fetch history
- Diagnostic information

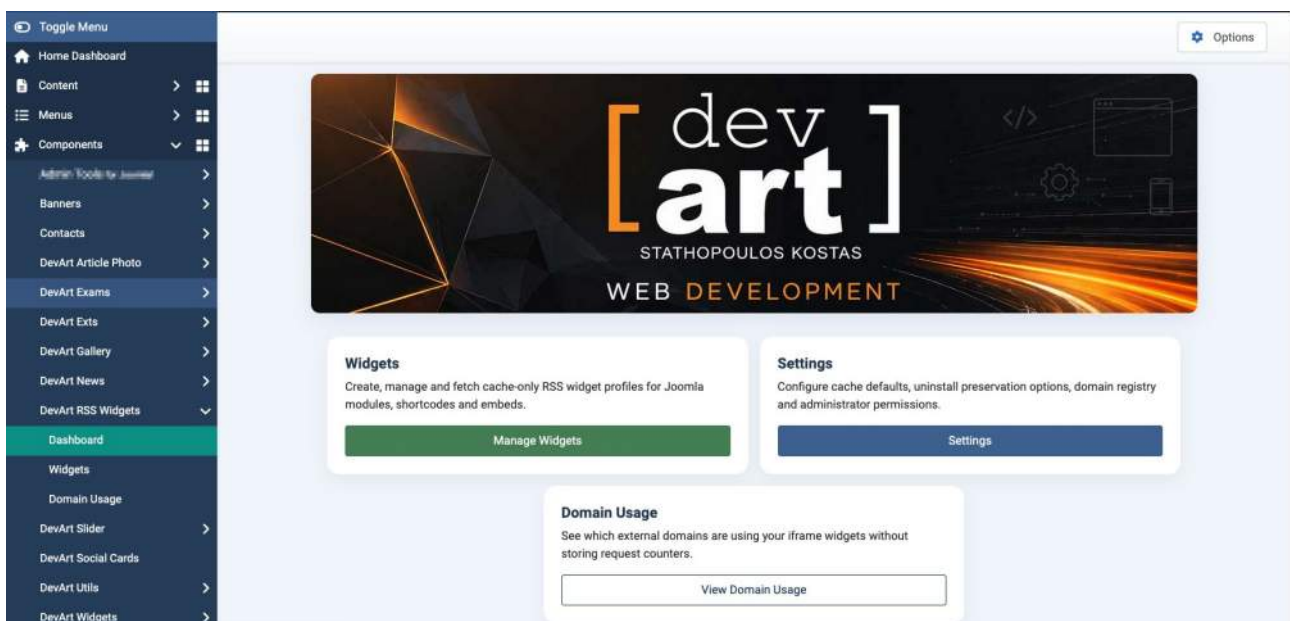
This allows clean migration between websites.

Recommended Workflow

For best results:

1. Create the widget.
2. Configure feeds.
3. Select a template.
4. Test using Fetch Now.
5. Verify frontend rendering.
6. Configure branding.
7. Generate embed codes if needed.
8. Deploy using modules, shortcodes or external embeds.
9. Enable scheduled fetching.
10. Monitor widget usage through Domain Usage if distributing externally.

The Widgets section is the central workspace for managing all RSS content distribution across Joomla websites and external platforms.



Toggle Menu

Home Dashboard

Content

Menus

Components

Submenus (Visible for Developer)

Banners

Contacts

DevArt Article Photo

DevArt Exams

DevArt Exts

DevArt Gallery

DevArt News

DevArt RSS Widgets

Dashboards

Widgets

Domain Usage

DevArt Slider

DevArt Social Cards

DevArt Utils

DevArt Widgets

New

Edit

Publish

Unpublish

Delete

Export Widgets

Options

[dev art]

STATHOPOULOS KOSTAS

Filter:

Status

Select number of items per page.

Title or alias

All

20

Search

Clear

Import Widgets Backup

Import Widgets

☐	ID	Title	Alias	Status	Layout	Max Items	Cache Lifetime (sec)	Date
☐	1	test.rss	test-rss	Published	grid_cards	9	5 min	2026-06-19 14:26:17

Page 1 of 1 · 1 widgets

Stathopoulos Kostas - DevArt

Toggle Menu

Home Dashboard

Content

Menus

Components

Submenus (Visible for Developer)

Banners

Contacts

DevArt Article Photo

DevArt Exams

DevArt Exts

DevArt Gallery

DevArt News

DevArt RSS Widgets

Dashboards

Widgets

Domain Usage

DevArt Slider

DevArt Social Cards

DevArt Utils

DevArt Widgets

Options

[dev art]

STATHOPOULOS KOSTAS

Filter:

Select number of items per page.

Domain, widget title or alias

50

Search

Clear

Domain Usage Registry is optional and disabled by default. When enabled, it records only widget, domain, first seen and last seen, throttled to one update per widget/domain/day. No hit counters are stored.

ID	Widget	Domain	Status	Access	First Seen	Last Seen
1	test.rss #1 test-rss	demo1.com.gr	allowed	Allowed	2026-05-30 17:39:26	2026-06-19 09:51:43
3	test.rss #1 test-rss	demo2.com.gr	allowed	Allowed	2026-06-18 15:00:24	2026-06-19 06:53:25
2	test.rss #1 test-rss	demo3.com	allowed	Blocked	2026-06-07 13:00:15	2026-06-07 13:00:15

Page 1 of 1 · 3 domains

SaveSave & CloseFetch NowCancel

Edit RSS Widget

Cache-only frontend architecture. RSS fetching stays admin/task only; frontend, shortcode and embeds only read generated JSON cache.

General

Data

Template

Branding

Embed

Advanced

Widget

Title *

test rss

Alias

test-rss

Leave empty to auto-generate. Alias will be made unique automatically.

Description / Comments

Internal notes for this widget

Published

☒ Yes

ID

1

General rule

This tab contains only Joomla/admin identity fields. RSS, cache, visual settings and embed settings are separated into their own tabs.

SaveSave & CloseFetch NowCancel

Edit RSS Widget

Cache-only frontend architecture. RSS fetching stays admin/task only; frontend, shortcode and embeds only read generated JSON cache.

General

Data

Template

Branding

Embed

Advanced

Feed Sources

RSS Feed URL

https://admin.feedburner.com/wordpress-feedburner-rss

Items

10

RSS Feed URL

https://feeds.feedburner.com/wordpress-feedburner-rss

Items

10

RSS Feed URL

https://feeds.feedburner.com/wordpress-feedburner-rss

Items

10

+ Add Feed

One RSS feed per row. Default item limit is 10 per feed. HTTP/HTTPS only. Local/private hosts are blocked.

Content Collection

Total Items

9

Ordering

Newest first

Applied when cache is generated. Frontend still reads cached JSON only.

Save Save & Close Fetch Now Cancel

Edit RSS Widget

Cache-only frontend architecture. RSS fetching stays admin/task only; frontend, shortcode and embeds only read generated JSON cache.

General Data Template Branding **Embed** Advanced

JavaScript Embed Code

Recommended for external websites. This script injects the selected widget template into a normal div and reads cached JSON only.

script embed

```
<div id="devart-rss-widget-1"></div>
<script>
  (function() {
    var widget = document.getElementById("devart-rss-widget-1");
    var script = document.createElement("script");
    script.src = "https://devart.com/devart-rss-widget-1.js";
    widget.appendChild(script);
  })();
</script>
```

Use this for Joomla, WordPress, static HTML and other external sites. Domain policy applies.

Copy script code

Preview script output

Iframe Embed Code

Use this code to display this cached widget on external sites. Embed output reads cached JSON only and never fetches RSS feeds live.

iframe embed

```
<iframe
  id="devart-rss-widget-1"
  src="https://devart.com/devart-rss-widget-1.js"></iframe>
```

DevArt RSS Widgets Configuration

Permissions

DevArt RSS Widgets Configuration

Fetch Mode

☒

Joomla Scheduled Task

Choose how RSS widgets are refreshed automatically. External cron URL is recommended for production servers.

Cron Token

devart-rss-widget-1.js

Generate Token

Generate a long random token, save Options, then copy the Cron URL or command below. Secret token for the secure auto-fetch cron endpoint.

Cron URL

https://devart.com/devart-rss-widget-1.js

Copy URL

Use this URL in Plesk, Webmin, cPanel or Linux cron.

Cron Command

curl -fsS "https://devart.com/devart-rss-widget-1.js"

Copy Command

Ready-to-copy curl command for server cron jobs.

Joomla Scheduled Task

Enable the DevArt RSS Widgets task plugin, then create a Joomla Scheduled Task using the DevArt RSS Fetch routine. External cron URL remains recommended for high-traffic production websites.

Cache Lifetime (sec)

300

Preserve Widget Data On Uninstall

☒

Yes

Keep DevArt RSS widget database tables when uninstalling. Recommended when you plan to reinstall or upgrade manually.